30 October 2025 at 1:10 pm

Observances on the pre-poll and voting last federal election

As a member of my [redacted] Party sub branch, I volunteered to help out at the pre-poll at Bowral and later on election day at the booth at Hill Top.

At Bowral it was obvious that most parties' helpers were much outnumbered by people giving out material from the nominated [redacted] Party member. All ho hats and t shirts that proclaimed this. A few were school age children. Because of their numbers, they tended to dominate the area right outside the entrance to the polling booth. This was drawn to the attention of the polling official in charge and she instructed the offenders to comply with the regulations.
Another intrusion was the signage. As I remember it was about 2m x 14m and hung on the building being used as the polling place. Again, a clear and blatant breach of the rules and this was ordered to be taken down as well. Similarly, a trailer displaying a huge banner was parked at the entrance to the park that voters had to navigate to get to the booth. This was also ordered two be taken down.

At Hill Top, there were similarities - our two helpers outnumbered by about twelve people wearing [redacted] insignia and signage put up early that morning that dominated the fences outside the school. Things were polite and congenial. Upon questioning some of these helpers I was told that a. They didn't live in th area, b.They didn't vote because of their religion.

David Robertson
[redacted]

30th October 2025